

THE LAST FIVE YEARS · THE SECOND SCREEN

The Cue Bible

build-2026-09-14R · the composed stage

141 cues · 14 songs · generated from the live show build, so this document cannot drift from what the phones actually do

THE STANDING RULE: the phone behaves exactly like a real phone. Tapping a notification IS the unlock — the app opens directly, no home screen. Inboxes and message lists load whole the instant the app opens, and a full life continues past the bottom edge of the glass. Only what would genuinely arrive right now — a text, a notification, new mail — appears live, and new mail lands at the top. Anything that violates this is a bug, even if it would make a nice theatrical beat.

How to read each entry: the header gives the cue ID, which screen, whose phone, the app, and the musical anchor. ON SCREEN is the complete content, verbatim and untruncated. PLAYS covers mechanics the engine performs on its own — navigation, self-timed animation, synthesized sound. PHONES gives the state after the cue when it changed. Gold notes carry dramaturgy, holds, and open director choices.

1 · Still Hurting CATHY SINGS · 20 FIRES

COLD OPEN. Her phone is the first actor on stage. The house learns the grammar wordlessly: a notification is tapped and the app is simply there; a list is already full; only what would truly arrive live ever arrives live. When she puts the phone down, the memories go full-bleed — non-diegetic, the frame gone.

1.1 SR · CATHY · Lock screen — PROLOGUE — *the wedding waltz begins. SHE is discovered on her phone.*

Preshow card out. Her phone, lit, already in her hand. JUNE 2026, the morning after.

ON SCREEN

STAMP → “JUNE 2026”

LOCK CLOCK — 9:41 · Friday, June 12, 2026

WALLPAPER — cast photo of JAMIE — she never changed it

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

PHONES SR = Lock screen · stamp “JUNE 2026” · clock 9:41

1.2 SR · CATHY · Lock screen — Prologue, next phrase

FACEBOOK pushes a Memories notification. The algorithm has no idea.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Facebook · Memories (now): “You have memories with Jamie Wellerstein to look back on today”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

1.3 SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories — Prologue — *she gives in*

She taps it. Face ID, straight into ON THIS DAY — and the screen leans in close so the house reads every card.

PLAYS

TAP THE NOTIFICATION — a beat on the banner, Face ID passes, and the app opens DIRECTLY onto Facebook Memories. One motion. No home screen. (No touch dot anywhere in the show — cut by direction; the screen’s own feedback carries every tap.)

SOUND

tap thock

PHONES SR = Facebook Memories · stamp “JUNE 2026” · clock 9:41

1.4 SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories — Prologue — *the first memory*

2021 — five years ago today. The first summer.

ON SCREEN

MEMORY CARD — 5 years ago · 2021 — Cathy Hiatt · June 12, 2021

post: “is it insane to be this happy after nine months”

media: M18 — first-date night walk

reactions: 👍 64

PLAYS

the feed advances one full-screen card · sound: soft pop

1.5 SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories — *Prologue — the second*

2022 — the year of the couch and the second Christmas.

ON SCREEN

MEMORY CARD — 4 years ago · 2022 — Cathy Hiatt · June 12, 2022

post: “our apartment has a name now. it is called The Couch.”

media: M15 — the hideous couch

reactions: 👍 88

PLAYS

the feed advances one full-screen card · sound: soft pop

1.6 SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories — *Prologue — the third*

2023 — the proposal. Her scroll stalls halfway with the card half-revealed — a beat of not being ready — then commits.

ON SCREEN

MEMORY CARD — 3 years ago · 2023 — Cathy Hiatt · June 12, 2023

post: “he asked. I said yes before he finished 💍”

media: M3a — the ring, the rowboat

reactions: 👍 341

PLAYS

the feed advances one full-screen card · sound: soft pop

1.7 SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories — *Prologue rolls into the INTRO of Still Hurting*

2024 — the wedding portrait. Dragged into view slowly, thumb never leaving the glass.

ON SCREEN

MEMORY CARD — 2 years ago · 2024 — Cathy Wellerstein · June 12, 2024

post: “married three weeks and 800 miles apart. worth it.”

media: M4 — the wedding portrait

reactions: 👍 402

PLAYS

the feed advances one full-screen card · sound: soft pop

1.8 SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories — *Intro — the last card*

2025 — the pier. Her first flick fails and the feed snaps back — she is not ready for this one — a long beat, then she drags it over herself.

ON SCREEN

MEMORY CARD — 1 year ago · 2025 — Cathy Wellerstein · June 12, 2025

post: “look who made it to Ohio 🥰”

media: M1 — the pier, golden hour

reactions: 👍 47

PLAYS

the feed advances one full-screen card · sound: soft pop

HOLD · *Five years in five cards, all before she sings a word. Let this one sit.*

1.9 SR · CATHY — *FIRST BAR of Still Hurting*

She puts the phone down. The song is hers — screen to black.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

1.10 SR · CATHY · Messages — *INTERLUDE, m. 58 — after “Like it’s simple, like it’s right.” She picks the phone back up.*

Unlock. Messages. Everyone already knows — the whole list is condolences.

ON SCREEN

MESSAGES LIST — loads whole, already full:

- Jamie — “You: please just call me” (Wednesday)
- Mom ❤️ • — “call me when you’re up. I love you.” (8:02 AM)
- Dana + girls 🍷 • — “Dana: we’re coming over at 7. non-negotiable.” (7:41 AM)
- Grammy • — “bubbeleh. are you eating?” (Yesterday)
- Beth — “just heard. I’m so so sorry ❤️” (Yesterday)
- Aunt Patti — “your mother told me. calling tonight” (Wednesday)
- Michael (voice) — “no lesson this week. take care of you.” (Tuesday)
- Ohio Housing — “Re: summer sublet – deposit received” (Monday)
- CVS Pharmacy — “Your prescription is ready for pickup” (Monday)
- Dentist – Dr. Okafor — “Reminder: cleaning Jun 22, 2:30 PM” (Sunday)

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

no animation — the list is already full; the last rows cut off at the bottom of the glass

SOUND

unlock swish

PHONES SR = Messages · stamp “JUNE 2026” · clock 9:41

1.11 SR · CATHY · Messages — *Interlude — she opens his thread*

His name, then the thread — mid-history, cold logistics from May going colder, days of her asking, all Delivered, all silent. Close-up on the conversation.

ON SCREEN

THREAD HISTORY — loads whole with the thread:

– May 12 · 6:40 PM

SENT (blue): “your mail is piling up here”

RECEIVED (gray): “I’ll come by this week”

SENT (blue): “ok”

– May 30 · 9:12 PM

SENT (blue): “the super needs to know about the lease by the 15th”

– Monday · 11:02 PM

SENT (blue): “are you coming home this weekend?”

– Wednesday · 8:15 AM

SENT (blue): “please just call me”

– Wednesday · 9:30 PM

SENT (blue): “I still have your ring”

status: Delivered

PLAYS

HESITATION — “Jamie” holds the iOS pressed-gray under a resting finger ... and does not commit. Holds until the next cue.

TAP COMMITS — the pressed row releases and pushes through · sound: tap

thread pushes in from the list — Jamie

1.12 SR · CATHY · Messages — *Interlude — she types it live*

PRESENT — 9:41 this morning. Typed in real time, hesitant.

ON SCREEN

thread caption: Today · 9:41 AM

TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “I’m not sure that I can do this without you”

PLAYS

sound: key clicks

SOUND

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

1.13 SR · CATHY · Messages — *Interlude — SHE SENDS IT*

Send. Delivered.

ON SCREEN

SEND – the draft springs up into the thread as a blue bubble

delivery status: Delivered

PLAYS

sound: send swoosh

SOUND

send whoosh

1.14 SR · CATHY · Messages — *What about lies, Jamie?*

Delivered → READ, 9:44. He is awake. He is holding his phone.

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK – 9:44

STATUS FLIPS → Read 9:44 AM

HOLD · *Let the receipt sit alone for a full phrase.*

1.15 SR · CATHY · Messages — *What about you, Jamie? — on the soft bloom*

His typing bubble rises. He is answering.

ON SCREEN

typing indicator rises (three dots)

1.16 SR · CATHY · Messages — *What about you?*

It stops. Nothing comes. He read it and put the phone down.

ON SCREEN

typing indicator disappears

HOLD · *The cruellest silence available in 2026.*

1.17 SR · CATHY — *She locks the phone*

She puts it down. Black.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK – the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

1.18 SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories — “Give me a day, Jamie!” — *the memories return, full screen*

NON-DIEGETIC — she is not holding the phone. The frame drops away and the feed fills the whole screen, resting on the wedding.

PLAYS

the full shell appears — CATHY’s screen

cut to Facebook Memories (instant)

PHONES SR = Facebook Memories · stamp “JUNE 2026” · clock 9:44

1.19 SR · CATHY · Facebook Memories — “Bring back the lies” — *back to the beginning*

The feed drifts back to the first summer — the happiest card, enormous, to close the song.

1.20 SR · CATHY — *FINAL CUTOFF*

HARD BLACK on the cutoff.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

2 · Shiksa Goddess **JAMIE SINGS · 11 FIRES**

THE FIRST NIGHT, FROM HIS SIDE. Three overwrought drafts die under the backspace key before two words survive: “home safe?” — the exact text the finale receives five years later. She answers by calling instead. His hesitation here is the measure for how fast he moves in 13.

2.1 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *Segue chord out of her blackout*

His phone, September 2021, 11:38 PM. Locked. Walking home.

ON SCREEN

STAMP → “SEPTEMBER 2021”

LOCK CLOCK — 11:38 · Friday, September 3, 2021

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

PHONES SL = Lock screen · stamp “SEPTEMBER 2021” · clock 11:38

2.2 SL · JAMIE · Messages — *I’m breaking my mother’s heart — THE SECOND TIME*

The phone comes out. Unlock, straight to Messages — her number sits on top, one hour old.

ON SCREEN

MESSAGES LIST — loads whole, already full:

- Cathy Hiatt ● — “it’s cathy 😊 — from tonight” (10:42 PM)
- Rob ● — “well??? how’d it go” (10:12 PM)
- Mom ❤️ ● — “dinner sunday. no excuses.” (8:05 PM)
- Linda Whitfield — “pages by Friday. I mean it.” (Yesterday)
- Elissa Weiss — “You: it was fun, but...” (Tuesday)
- H. Greenblatt — “ok. good luck with the book I guess” (Monday)
- S. Rosen — “You: I’ll call you this week” (2 wks ago)
- Columbia workshop — “Adam: notes attached for Thursday” (2 wks ago)

PLAYS

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

no animation — the list is already full; the last rows cut off at the bottom of the glass

SOUND

unlock swish

PHONES SL = Messages · stamp “SEPTEMBER 2021” · clock 11:38

2.3 SL · JAMIE · Messages — Before “...my grandfather’s rolling in his grave” — the first draft

Her thread — one message in it: her number. He types a long, overwrought draft in full.

ON SCREEN

THREAD HISTORY — loads whole with the thread:

— Today · 10:42 PM

RECEIVED (gray): “it’s cathy 😊 — from tonight”

LOCK CLOCK — 11:39

TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “Tonight was maybe the best night of my whole life”

PLAYS

HESITATION — “Cathy Hiatt” holds the iOS pressed-gray under a resting finger ... and does not commit. Holds until the next cue.

TAP COMMITS — the pressed row releases and pushes through · sound: tap

thread pushes in from the list — Cathy Hiatt

sound: key clicks

SOUND

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

2.4 SL · JAMIE · Messages — Still before the grandfather line — deleted; a bolder one

Backspaces every character, then tries again, bolder.

ON SCREEN

BACKSPACES the draft to nothing (fast rattle)

TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “So when can I see you again. Tomorrow?”

PLAYS

sound: backspace rattle

sound: key clicks

SOUND

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

rapid delete clicks

2.5 SL · JAMIE · Messages — ...and that one goes too

Deleted. 11:41. Failing to write a text on a sidewalk.

ON SCREEN

BACKSPACES the draft to nothing (fast rattle)

LOCK CLOCK — 11:41

PLAYS

sound: backspace rattle

SOUND

rapid delete clicks

2.6 SL · JAMIE — He pockets the phone

Black while he sings.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

2.7 SL · JAMIE · Messages — “I’ve been standing for days with the phone in my hand” — it comes back out

The thread again. 11:47.

ON SCREEN

THREAD HISTORY – loads whole with the thread:

– Today · 10:42 PM

RECEIVED (gray): “it’s cathy 😊 – from tonight”

LOCK CLOCK – 11:47

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen
cut to Messages (instant)

2.8 SL · JAMIE · Messages — “Like an idiot, scared to death” — he finally sends it

Two words: “home safe?” — typed and SENT. The finale receives this exact text at 11:58.

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK – 11:48

thread caption: · 11:48 PM

TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “home safe?”

SEND – the draft springs up into the thread as a blue bubble

delivery status: Delivered

PLAYS

sound: key clicks
sound: send swoosh

SOUND

send whoosh
keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

2.9 SL · JAMIE · Messages — Under the vamp

Her typing bubble appears — and stays up.

ON SCREEN

typing indicator rises (three dots)

2.10 SL · JAMIE · Phone — “And if you had a pierced tongue” — he is ON THE PHONE with Cathy

The bubble never resolves as a text — she called instead. Connected call, her name on his screen.

ON SCREEN

CALL SCREEN – Cathy Hiatt · incoming call · incoming

call state → connected · 00:14

SOUND

outgoing ring

PHONES SL = Phone · stamp “SEPTEMBER 2021” · clock 11:48

2.11 SL · JAMIE — Call ends — phone away just before “breaking the circle”

Black, and it does not come back out. Nothing else until See I’m Smiling.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK – the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

3 · See I'm Smiling BOTH SING · 12 FIRES

NEARLY EMPTY, BY DESIGN. One post and its climbing likes are the whole birthday; the screens stay black while she sings. Then his 2021 calls cut in — the agency cold call, the callback, and Rob (an outgoing dial, per the script) — and the house learns the projections can time-travel.

3.1 BOTH · CATHY · Facebook — *Scene change — her phone rolls back to July 19, 2025*

Ohio, her birthday. Facebook opens on the post she just made — the pier photo.

ON SCREEN

STAMP → "JULY 2025 · OHIO"

LOCK CLOCK — 6:12 · Saturday, July 19, 2025

SOCIAL POST — **Cathy Wellerstein (now)**: "look who made it to Ohio 🥳 best birthday present"

media: M1 — cast photo: the pier, golden hour

reactions: 👍 47

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY's screen

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Facebook — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

sound: soft pop

SOUND

unlock swish

PHONES BOTH = Facebook · stamp "JULY 2025 · OHIO" · clock 6:12

3.2 BOTH · CATHY · Facebook — *A beat later*

The likes climb.

ON SCREEN

LIKE COUNTER SPINS → 47

3.3 BOTH · CATHY — *She puts the phone away*

Black — the screens stay out of the song until the calls.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

3.4 BOTH · JAMIE · Phone — *"And you're mine... We're doing fine." — JAMIE DIALS. Time snaps back.*

HIS phone, 2021 — a cold call to the agency, via Dr. Adler. She is not his agent yet, so the phone shows the business listing, not a contact. (Script fact: Whitfield is his literary agent at her own agency; Elise is the editor at Random House.)

ON SCREEN

STAMP → "SEPTEMBER 2021"

LOCK CLOCK — 2:41 · Tuesday, September 14, 2021

CALL SCREEN — Whitfield Literary Agency · calling... · outgoing

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE's screen

SOUND

outgoing ring

PHONES BOTH = Phone · stamp "SEPTEMBER 2021" · clock 2:41

3.5 BOTH · JAMIE · Phone — *On his “Hi — I’m calling for Miss Whitfield”*

It connects. The conversation runs.

ON SCREEN

call state → connected · 00:08

3.6 BOTH · JAMIE — *Through “what’s your address” — he hangs up*

Black. Time returns to her.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

3.7 BOTH · JAMIE · Phone — *“It’s all right — We’ll have tonight.” — the agency calls HIM back*

HIS phone again, 2021 — an INCOMING call from Miss Whitfield.

ON SCREEN

STAMP → “SEPTEMBER 2021”

LOCK CLOCK — 4:18 · Tuesday, September 14, 2021

CALL SCREEN — Whitfield Literary Agency · incoming call · incoming

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

SOUND

outgoing ring

3.8 BOTH · JAMIE · Phone — *“Hello... this is— oh, Miss Whitfield.” He answers*

Connected. It runs until the thank-you.

ON SCREEN

call state → connected · 00:21

3.9 BOTH · JAMIE — *Through “thank you — this is great” — it ends*

Black again.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

3.10 BOTH · JAMIE · Phone — *After Cathy’s “And not do anything at all” — JAMIE DIALS ROB*

SCRIPT: he dials — “perplexed but not unhappy.” The lease is up; an apartment WITH Cathy. 2021, pre-move-in — the era question answers itself.

ON SCREEN

STAMP → “SEPTEMBER 2021”

LOCK CLOCK — 8:02 · Tuesday, September 14, 2021

CALL SCREEN — Rob · calling mobile... · outgoing

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

SOUND

outgoing ring

3.11 BOTH · JAMIE · Phone — *Rob picks up — “Yeah, listen. You know how my lease is up?”*

Connected — visible through the very end of the vamp.

ON SCREEN

call state → connected · 01:02

3.12 BOTH · JAMIE — *DOWNBEAT of Moving Too Fast — he hangs up*

Black. Song 4 takes over.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

4 · Moving Too Fast **BOTH SING · 10 FIRES**

THE AVALANCHE, COMPRESSED. Her one professional call, politely deflected — then his lock screen wins five times in the exact order he sings them: the apartment, the Atlantic, the money, Columbia, Sonny. The happy infrastructure of the marriage installs itself so the back half can dismantle it.

4.1 **BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen** — *Count-off — drums in*

His phone, October 2021. Locked and quiet.

ON SCREEN

STAMP → “OCTOBER 2021”

LOCK CLOCK — 2:14 · Friday, October 8, 2021

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

PHONES BOTH = Lock screen · stamp “OCTOBER 2021” · clock 2:14

4.2 **BOTH · CATHY · Phone** — *“But oh, oh — what else am I s’posed to do?” — CATHY DIALS*

HER phone — the gig-hunting era (2024, per the show’s structure; script gives no date) — dialing Mike Stelmyer. Script fact: his agency is never named.

ON SCREEN

STAMP → “2024”

LOCK CLOCK — 10:10

CALL SCREEN — Mike Stelmyer · calling... · outgoing

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

SOUND

outgoing ring

PHONES BOTH = Phone · stamp “2024” · clock 10:10

4.3 **BOTH · CATHY · Phone** — *On her “Hello, this is Catherine Hiatt, I’m calling for Mike Stelmyer” — it connects*

We see the dial AND the connect.

ON SCREEN

call state → connected · 00:15

4.4 **BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen** — *“I’ll call you soon!” — the call ends*

Back to HIS phone, October 2021, locked — ready for the run of wins.

ON SCREEN

STAMP → “OCTOBER 2021”

LOCK CLOCK — 2:14 · Friday, October 8, 2021

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

PHONES BOTH = Lock screen · stamp “OCTOBER 2021” · clock 2:14

4.5 BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen — “*Found an apartment on Seventy-Third!*”

Move-in day pops up, both names on the day.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Calendar · MOVE-IN DAY 📅 — W 73rd St (now): “Saturday, Oct 16 · 9:00 AM · with Cathy Hiatt”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

4.6 BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen — “*The Atlantic Monthly’s printing my first chapter*”

The Atlantic says yes.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Mail · The Atlantic Monthly (now): “We are delighted to publish your excerpt”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

4.7 BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen — “*Two thousand bucks without rewriting one word!*”

The deposit lands.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Chase (now): “You received a deposit of \$2,000.00”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

4.8 BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen — “*I left Columbia and don’t regret it*”

The withdrawal confirmation.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Mail · Columbia University (now): “Withdrawal processed – Fall term ✓”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

4.9 BOTH · JAMIE · Lock screen — “*I wrote a book and Sonny Mehta read it!*”

THE BIGGEST HIT.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Messages · Linda Whitfield (now): “SONNY READ IT. CALL ME NOW.”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

4.10 BOTH · JAMIE — *Button*

Black.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK – the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

5 · I'm a Part of That CATHY SINGS · 13 FIRES

HIS SILENCE, FROM HER SIDE. The party album has her as “and guest”; the repost crops her out; her texts sit Not Delivered under six hours of his Do Not Disturb. The 6:04 release — everything flips Delivered at once — is the quiet center of the song. Then a stranger’s photo of the dedication page.

5.1 SR · CATHY · Lock screen — *Intro figure*

Her phone, March 2025.

ON SCREEN

STAMP → “MARCH 2025”

LOCK CLOCK — 11:20 · Sunday, March 9, 2025

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

PHONES SR = Lock screen · stamp “MARCH 2025” · clock 11:20

5.2 SR · CATHY · Facebook — “One day we’re just like ‘Leave It to Beaver’”

She opens Facebook herself — and finds the party album. She is “and guest.”

ON SCREEN

SOCIAL POST — Random House Events (now): “Publication party! Tagged: Jamie Wellerstein and guest”

media: M7 — cast photo: party, Cathy at the frame’s edge

reactions: 👍 180

PLAYS

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Facebook — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

sound: soft pop

SOUND

unlock swish

PHONES SR = Facebook · stamp “MARCH 2025” · clock 11:20

5.3 SR · CATHY · Facebook — “And then he’s off on a trip to Jamie-land”

A fan account reposts it — cropped without her.

ON SCREEN

SOCIAL POST — bookish_nyc (now): “the man of the hour ✨”

media: M7b — SAME PHOTO, RE-CROPPED — Cathy gone

reactions: 👍 322

PLAYS

sound: soft pop

5.4 SR · CATHY · Facebook — *And I’m a part of that.*

She comments on it anyway. Lovingly.

ON SCREEN

COMMENT APPEARS — Cathy: “❤️ so proud of this one”

5.5 SR · CATHY · Messages — “Staring catatonic out the window”

She opens his thread — yesterday’s ordinary warmth still sitting above, which makes today’s NOT DELIVERED colder.

ON SCREEN

THREAD HISTORY – loads whole with the thread:

– Tuesday · 8:12 AM

RECEIVED (gray): “gym then pages. love you”

SENT (blue): “bring back oat milk”

RECEIVED (gray): “👍”

– Thursday · 6:30 PM

SENT (blue): “callback went ok I think?? they laughed at the right spot”

RECEIVED (gray): “of course they did”

– Yesterday · 7:20 PM

RECEIVED (gray): “don’t wait up. this chapter is winning”

SENT (blue): “leftovers in the fridge. go get it, killer”

– Today · 12:04 PM

SENT (blue): “lunch?”

status: Not Delivered

PLAYS

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SR = Messages · stamp “MARCH 2025” · clock 11:20

5.6 SR · CATHY · Messages — “Barely even breathing all the while...”

1:37. She tries again. Nothing.

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK – 1:37

thread caption: · 1:37 PM

TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “ok eating without you”

PLAYS

sound: key clicks

SOUND

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

5.7 SR · CATHY · Messages — (phrase button)

Sent into the void. Not Delivered.

ON SCREEN

SEND – the draft springs up into the thread as a blue bubble

delivery status: Not Delivered

PLAYS

sound: send swoosh

SOUND

send whoosh

5.8 SR · CATHY · Messages — “*Next day it’s just like it never happened*”

3:15. Six hours of Do Not Disturb, from her side of it.

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK – 3:15

thread caption: · 3:15 PM

TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “we’re out of coffee fyi”

SEND – the draft springs up into the thread as a blue bubble

delivery status: Not Delivered

PLAYS

sound: key clicks

sound: send swoosh

SOUND

send whoosh

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

5.9 SR · CATHY · Messages — “*And then he smiles*”

THE RELEASE — everything flips to Delivered at once. He woke up. (Clock: 6:04 PM.)

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK – 6:04

STATUS FLIPS → Delivered ✓

HOLD · *The tightest band sync in the song. Land it on the smile.*

5.10 SR · CATHY · Facebook — *SHE opens the book and closes it.*

Back to Facebook — a reader has photographed the dedication page.

ON SCREEN

SOCIAL POST – a reader (now): “That dedication page though 🙄”

media: M12 – the dedication page: “For Cathy”

reactions: 👍 41

PLAYS

OPENS Facebook — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

sound: soft pop

PHONES SR = Facebook · stamp “MARCH 2025” · clock 6:04

5.11 SR · CATHY · Facebook — *(two bars later)*

Likes climb.

ON SCREEN

LIKE COUNTER SPINS → 41

5.12 SR · CATHY · Search — “*I’m a part of that... Aren’t I?*”

In the clear — she leaves Facebook, opens Safari, and types it into Google. The loneliest cue in the show.

ON SCREEN

SEARCH BAR – types live: “is it normal to feel invisible at your husband’s party”

PLAYS

OPENS Safari — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SR = Search · stamp “MARCH 2025” · clock 6:04

5.13 SR · CATHY · Search — *As the song ends*

She clears it.

ON SCREEN

search BACKSPACED clear

6 · The Schmuel Song **JAMIE SINGS · 2 FIRES**

STILLNESS, BY DIRECTION. One held Christmas image. No animation, no cueing inside the number — the kindest screen of the night, deliberately so; the generosity buys the betrayal its full price later. Not one Elise pixel anywhere in this song.

6.1 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *Christmas — the story is his to tell*

No animations, by direction: the phone just keeps the season. Lock screen, Christmas wallpaper (photo TBD — M23), December 2022.

ON SCREEN

STAMP → “DECEMBER 2022”

LOCK CLOCK — 9:12 · Saturday, December 24, 2022

WALLPAPER — Christmas — tree lights (photo TBD · M23)

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

PHONES SL = Lock screen · stamp “DECEMBER 2022” · clock 9:12

6.2 SL · JAMIE — *Cutoff*

Black.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

7 · A Summer in Ohio CATHY SINGS · 2 FIRES

ONE CUE. The prerecorded FaceTime (V2) carries the entire number — Jamie at his desk, half-attending, writing, while Ohio sings to him. The engine draws only the FaceTime frame and the call chrome; everything alive in it is the video.

7.1 SR · CATHY · FaceTime — TOP OF THE SONG — one cue fires the whole number

Cathy's laptop, full screen: the prerecorded FaceTime plays with the FaceTime overlays on. We see ONLY Jamie — no self-view of Cathy — reacting to her words for the entire song. Video produced separately (V2).

ON SCREEN

STAMP → "JUNE 2024 · OHIO"

LOCK CLOCK — 9:38 · Friday, June 21, 2024

FACETIME — Jamie · FaceTime Video

main feed: V2 — JAMIE AT HIS DESK · the prerecorded FaceTime plays here

PLAYS

the MacBook shell appears — CATHY's screen

SOUND

FaceTime trill, then connect pop

PHONES SR = FaceTime · stamp "JUNE 2024 · OHIO" · clock 9:38

HOLD · *Nothing else to fire until the cutoff. The video carries the number.*

7.2 SR · CATHY — End of the song

Black.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

8 · The Next Ten Minutes BOTH SING · 4 FIRES

TIME, NOT CONTENT. The phones mark only where we are: June 12, 2023 — then the one date both timelines share, enormous: MAY 18, 2024 — then back again on the rowboat line. The era rail does the traveling; the people do the vows.

8.1 BOTH · CATHY · Lock screen — “No, that one’s Jerry Seinfeld... No, the Dakota —” · the rowboat, the question
No animations, by direction: the phones only mark WHERE WE ARE IN TIME. The rowboat on the Central Park lake — “No, the Dakota” — pointing at the Upper West Side. The engagement day.

ON SCREEN

STAMP → “JUNE 12, 2023”

LOCK CLOCK — 4:44 · Monday, June 12, 2023

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

PHONES BOTH = Lock screen · stamp “JUNE 12, 2023” · clock 4:44

8.2 BOTH · CATHY · Lock screen — AT THE VOWS — the underscore turns

The only date both timelines will ever share, enormous.

ON SCREEN

STAMP → “MAY 18, 2024 · THE WEDDING”

LOCK CLOCK — 6:47 · Saturday, May 18, 2024

PHONES BOTH = Lock screen · stamp “MAY 18, 2024 · THE WEDDING” · clock 6:47

8.3 BOTH · CATHY · Lock screen — CATHY’s “Is that one John Lennon?” — back in time to the engagement

The clock rolls back to the beginning of the piece.

ON SCREEN

STAMP → “JUNE 12, 2023”

LOCK CLOCK — 4:44 · Monday, June 12, 2023

PHONES BOTH = Lock screen · stamp “JUNE 12, 2023” · clock 4:44

8.4 BOTH · CATHY — Cutoff

Black.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK — the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

9 · A Miracle Would Happen JAMIE SINGS · 7 FIRES

NOTIFICATIONS ONLY. His married year arrives as a stack he never touches — readers, the growing book, Elise, front row. The phone will not stop, and he never once interacts with it. The attention just lands.

9.1 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *Vamp — his phone, locked*

October 2024. Married, at a party, and the phone will not stop. He never touches it — the attention just arrives.

ON SCREEN

STAMP → “OCTOBER 2024”

LOCK CLOCK — 11:22 · Friday, October 18, 2024

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

PHONES SL = Lock screen · stamp “OCTOBER 2024” · clock 11:22

9.2 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *“Every other woman in the world suddenly finds you attractive”*

A reader.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Instagram · @a.reader.somewhere (now): “okay the ending WRECKED me. how are you real”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

9.3 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *“And now they’re banging down your door”*

And another.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Instagram · @lit.with.lena (now): “sent you a message request”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

9.4 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *“I’m at these parties... I’m the grand fromage”*

The book keeps growing without him.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Goodreads (now): “Your book passed 10,000 ratings · ★ 4.6”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

9.5 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *“And here she comes: ‘Let’s get a cup of coffee...’” — Elise*

And Elise.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION — Messages · Elise · Ed. (now): “proofs went out 🥳 celebratory drink sometime?”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

9.6 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — “*It’s a challenge to resist temptation*”

Front row.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION – Instagram · @novel.annie (now): “front row at your reading tonight 📖”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

9.7 SL · JAMIE — *Button*

Black.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK – the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

10 · Climbing Uphill CATHY SINGS · 13 FIRES

HER INTERIOR VS. HIS SCROLL. The bell-tone fragments rhyme with the sung monologue and never transcribe it — protect that rule in every edit.

10.1 SR · CATHY · Mail – reading — Intro

Her phone, February 2024, 6:02 AM. Audition day starts in Mail — the breakdown, opened and read.

ON SCREEN

STAMP → “FEBRUARY 2024”

LOCK CLOCK – 6:02 · Monday, February 5, 2024

INBOX – loads whole, the instant the app opens:

- Casting Networks • – BREAKDOWN – new musical (Equity) – F, 20s. Legit soprano to high C... (5:12 AM)
- Casting Office – Thank you for auditioning – We enjoyed meeting you. At this time... (Thursday)
- Backstage – 9 new roles match your profile – Apply today (Wednesday)
- Mom – Fwd: saw this and thought of you (Tuesday)
- Chase – Your statement is ready (Monday)

THE EMAIL, OPENED – Casting Networks → Cathy Hiatt-Wellerstein · “BREAKDOWN – new musical (Equity)” · 5:12 AM

SEEKING: F, 20s–30s.

Legit soprano to high C. Strong dancer.

MUST READ YOUNG.

Submit headshot & résumé. Sign-in opens 6:30 AM.

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

cut to Mail (instant)

no animation — a real inbox does not populate; it is simply THERE, continuing past the bottom edge

HESITATION — “Casting Networks” holds the iOS pressed-gray under a resting finger ... and does not commit. Holds until the next cue.

the row presses through — the email pushes in over the inbox

PHONES SR = Mail – reading · stamp “FEBRUARY 2024” · clock 6:02

10.2 SR · CATHY · Mail – reading — “I’m climbin’ uphill, Daddy”

The check-in text lands over the breakdown: she is number two hundred.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION – Messages · Audition Check-In (now): “You’re checked in: #200 of 200. Estimated wait: 3 hr 40 min.”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

10.3 SR · CATHY · Mail – reading — *(phrase button)*

The bank tells her what the headshots cost. Another banner, worse.

ON SCREEN

NOTIFICATION – Chase (now): “Declined: \$175.00 – REPRO-HEADSHOTS NYC. Available balance: \$23.41.”

PLAYS

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

10.4 SR · CATHY · Search — *FIRST BELL TONE*

Her head, typed into Google and never searched. Never a caption of what she sings.

ON SCREEN

SEARCH BAR – types live: “smile. breathe. don’t look at your shoes.”

PLAYS

OPENS Safari — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SR = Search · stamp “FEBRUARY 2024” · clock 6:02

HOLD · *Bells are the tightest MD sync in the show. One fragment per bell.*

10.5 SR · CATHY · Search — *Second bell*

“196 to go.”

ON SCREEN

SEARCH BAR – types live: “196 to go”

10.6 SR · CATHY · Search — *Third bell*

“quiet till 6, he’s writing.”

ON SCREEN

SEARCH BAR – types live: “quiet till 6, he’s writing”

10.7 SR · CATHY · Search — *Fourth bell*

“he didn’t ask about the callback.”

ON SCREEN

SEARCH BAR – types live: “he didn’t ask about the callback”

10.8 SR · CATHY · Search — *Fifth bell*

“what am I doing here.”

ON SCREEN

SEARCH BAR – types live: “what am I doing here”

10.9 SR · CATHY · Facebook — *(his interruption section)*

She closes Safari and scrolls HIS press instead. The review, going viral.

ON SCREEN

SOCIAL POST – BOOKS Weekly (now): “THE WELLERSTEIN MOMENT – the year’s most talked-about debut”

reactions: 👍 4212

PLAYS

OPENS Facebook — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

sound: soft pop

PHONES SR = Facebook · stamp “FEBRUARY 2024” · clock 6:02

10.10 SR · CATHY · Facebook — *(with the build)*

4,212 and climbing, while she waits in a hallway.

ON SCREEN

LIKE COUNTER SPINS → 4212

10.11 SR · CATHY · Facebook — *(call section)*

SEED FIVE — the party photo. A figure half in frame, never named.

ON SCREEN

SOCIAL POST – Random House · tagged (now): “celebrating the review!!”

media: M8 – cast photo: bar celebration · a figure half in frame

reactions: 👍 64

PLAYS

sound: soft pop

10.12 SR · CATHY · Search — *AFTER THE LAST BELL — in the clear*

Back to Safari. Her search bar.

ON SCREEN

SEARCH BAR – types live: “how to quit acting gracefully”

PLAYS

OPENS Safari — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SR = Search · stamp “FEBRUARY 2024” · clock 6:02

10.13 SR · CATHY · Search — *As the final vamp dies*

Cleared.

ON SCREEN

search BACKSPACED clear

11 · If I Didn't Believe In You JAMIE SINGS · 10 FIRES

THE FIGHT HAS AN AUDIENCE: HIS PHONE. What the argument is actually about sits unsigned on the other side of the stage all song.

11.1 SL · JAMIE · calevent — *The fight is already underway.*

His phone, March 2026. The party invite on the real Calendar — his ✓ and her ✗ on the same screen.

ON SCREEN

STAMP → "MARCH 2026"

LOCK CLOCK — 7:41 · Friday, March 6, 2026

CALENDAR EVENT — "Publication Party — Book 2 🦋" · Tonight · 7:30 PM · 1745 Broadway

invitees: Jamie Wellerstein ✓ · Cathy Hiatt-Wellerstein ✗

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE's screen

cut to calevent (instant)

PHONES SL = calevent · stamp "MARCH 2026" · clock 7:41

11.2 SL · JAMIE · Messages — *If I didn't believe in you,*

Elise texts, mid-argument — he opens the thread, and it visibly has a past.

ON SCREEN

THREAD HISTORY — loads whole with the thread:

— Feb 2025 · 1:14 AM

RECEIVED (gray): "still up? this chapter is killing me 😊"

SENT (blue): "for you I'm always up"

— Today · 7:41 PM

RECEIVED (gray): "are you coming or not?"

PLAYS

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SL = Messages · stamp "MARCH 2026" · clock 7:41

11.3 SL · JAMIE · Messages — *We wouldn't be having this fight.*

She double-texts.

ON SCREEN

RECEIVED BUBBLE (gray): "people are asking where you are."

11.4 SL · JAMIE · Messages — *If I didn't believe in you —*

"fine." The deadliest text in the show.

ON SCREEN

RECEIVED BUBBLE (gray): "fine."

HOLD · *Phrase button, then let it sit in silence.*

11.5 SL · JAMIE · Messages — “I’d walk out the door and say, ‘Cathy, you’re right’”

He types a reply.

ON SCREEN

TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “leaving in 10”

PLAYS

sound: key clicks

SOUND

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

11.6 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — [CHOICE — ALONZO] send it, or pocket it

He does NOT send. Phone in pocket, screen locked. Two very different Jamies.

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK — 9:12

PLAYS

cut to Lock screen (instant)

PHONES SL = Lock screen · stamp “MARCH 2026” · clock 9:12

HOLD · *Decide in tech.*

11.7 SL · JAMIE · Facebook — *THE PEAK of the bridge*

A memory resurfaces on his own phone: his own words, three years ago.

ON SCREEN

SOCIAL POST — Memories (now): ““EVERYONE go see my brilliant wife tonight. Front row forever.””

reactions: 👍 131

PLAYS

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Facebook — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

sound: soft pop

SOUND

unlock swish

PHONES SL = Facebook · stamp “MARCH 2026” · clock 9:12

HOLD · *The word “believe” curdles in real time.*

11.8 SL · JAMIE · Facebook — *(two bars later)*

Likes climb on the corpse of it.

ON SCREEN

LIKE COUNTER SPINS → 131

11.9 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *ON THE BLACKOUT*

A notification he will not see until morning; she signed the Ohio contract.

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK – 11:47

NOTIFICATION – Mail · Summer Season (Ohio) (11:47 PM): “Contract received – C. Hiatt ✓”

PLAYS

cut to Lock screen (instant)

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

PHONES SL = Lock screen · stamp “MARCH 2026” · clock 11:47

HOLD · *She made the decision while he was arguing.*

11.10 SL · JAMIE — *Final cutoff*

Black.

ON SCREEN

HOUSE BLACK – the phone vanishes into it

PLAYS

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

12 · I Can Do Better Than That CATHY SINGS · 11 FIRES

HER GHOST REGISTER, USED FOR LOVE. Drafted courage, kept receipts, a shared playlist — the exact mirror of what his register becomes.

12.1 SR · CATHY · maps — *Vamp — the drive*

Her phone, November 2021. Real turn-by-turn: three hours forty to the Eastern Shore.

ON SCREEN

STAMP → “NOVEMBER 2021”

LOCK CLOCK — 4:05 · Saturday, November 6, 2021

MAPS NAVIGATION — Merge onto NJ Tpke S · via I-95 S

ETA card: 3 hr 40 min → Eastern Shore, MD

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

cut to maps (instant)

PHONES SR = maps · stamp “NOVEMBER 2021” · clock 4:05

12.2 SR · CATHY · music — “My best friend had a little situation at the end of our senior year”

She switches to Music — the collaborative playlist, real screen. He has already added three songs. The finale leaves it.

ON SCREEN

MUSIC — **playlist** “US 🎧” · Collaborative Playlist — Jamie & Cathy

♪ (greeked track) — Added by Jamie ✨

♪ (greeked track) — Added by Jamie ✨

♪ (greeked track) — Added by Jamie ✨

♪ (greeked track) — Added by you

PLAYS

OPENS Music — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SR = music · stamp “NOVEMBER 2021” · clock 4:05

12.3 SR · CATHY · Facebook — “And like a shot, she and Mitchell got married that summer”

She opens Facebook — Carolann’s settled life, scrolling past.

ON SCREEN

SOCIAL POST — **Carolann (now)**: “MR & MRS MITCHELL 📖”

media: M11a — hometown wedding

reactions: 👍 74

PLAYS

OPENS Facebook — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

sound: soft pop

PHONES SR = Facebook · stamp “NOVEMBER 2021” · clock 4:05

12.4 SR · CATHY · Facebook — “Carolann getting bigger ev’ry minute”

The baby.

ON SCREEN

SOCIAL POST — **Carolann (now)**: “he’s here ❤️”

media: M11b — baby announcement

reactions: 👍 118

PLAYS

sound: soft pop

12.5 SR · CATHY · Facebook — “They got a little cute house... with a crucifix on the door”

The house, crucifix on the door.

ON SCREEN

SOCIAL POST – Carolann (now): “our first HOUSE 🏠”

media: M11c – first house

reactions: 👍 203

PLAYS

sound: soft pop

12.6 SR · CATHY · shot — (*the ex verse*)

She opens Photos — she kept the receipt: a screenshot saved a year ago, caption and all.

ON SCREEN

PHOTOS – a saved screenshot, opened: Screenshots · Saved Nov 2020

inside the screenshot (gray bubble): “I think I need to focus on my career right now. You’re great. – R”

caption: her caption: “a heartfelt letter, apparently”

PLAYS

OPENS Photos — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SR = shot · stamp “NOVEMBER 2021” · clock 4:05

12.7 SR · CATHY · Messages — *THE DRAFTS – pre-chorus*

She opens his thread — two months deep — then three weeks of drafted courage begin. Draft one, October 12.

ON SCREEN

THREAD HISTORY – loads whole with the thread:

– Oct 3 · 9:20 PM

RECEIVED (gray): “one month anniversary of “home safe?””

SENT (blue): “you kept the date??”

RECEIVED (gray): “I keep everything”

– Thursday · 11:02 PM

SENT (blue): “my radiator died again 🤖”

RECEIVED (gray): “MY radiator works fine. just saying”

thread caption: · DRAFTS · NEVER SENT

TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “so my lease is up in...”

PLAYS

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

sound: key clicks

SOUND

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

PHONES SR = Messages · stamp “NOVEMBER 2021” · clock 4:05

12.8 SR · CATHY · Messages — *(next phrase)*

Draft two, two weeks later. Braver.

ON SCREEN

BACKSPACES the draft to nothing (fast rattle)

caption: OCT 12 · deleted

TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “how attached are you to your apartment”

PLAYS

sound: backspace rattle

sound: key clicks

SOUND

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

rapid delete clicks

12.9 SR · CATHY · Messages — *(last phrase before the chorus)*

Draft three. All caps. Still not sent.

ON SCREEN

BACKSPACES the draft to nothing (fast rattle)

caption: OCT 26 · deleted

TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “MOVE IN WITH ME (too much?)”

PLAYS

sound: backspace rattle

sound: key clicks

SOUND

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

rapid delete clicks

HOLD · *Her ghosts are made of courage. His are made of cowardice.*

12.10 SR · CATHY · Messages — “Say you’ll move in with me” — *deleted; she asks him out loud*

Deleted. She puts the phone down and asks him out loud instead.

ON SCREEN

BACKSPACES the draft to nothing (fast rattle)

caption: NOV 2 · deleted – she asks out loud instead

PLAYS

sound: backspace rattle

SOUND

rapid delete clicks

12.11 SR · CATHY · maps — *(final chorus)*

Back to Maps. Twelve minutes out — the nav says arriving; so does she.

ON SCREEN

MAPS NAVIGATION – Continue straight · MD-33 W

ETA card: 12 min → Eastern Shore, MD · ARRIVING (green)

PLAYS

OPENS Maps — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SR = maps · stamp “NOVEMBER 2021” · clock 4:05

13 · Nobody Needs to Know JAMIE SINGS · 14 FIRES

THE PAYOFF. The same three gestures as the first night, frozen over. Speed that read as charm now reads as practice.

13.1 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — *Intro, bar 1*

His phone lights the dark. June 2026, 6:12 AM. Not his bed.

ON SCREEN

STAMP → “JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN”

LOCK CLOCK — 6:12 · Friday, June 12, 2026

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

PHONES SL = Lock screen · stamp “JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN” · clock 6:12

13.2 SL · JAMIE · Messages — *Bar 2*

Unlocked before the house has settled. Straight to Messages. No hesitation — that is the point.

PLAYS

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

cut to Messages (instant)

SOUND

unlock swish

PHONES SL = Messages · stamp “JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN” · clock 6:12

HOLD · *Her opening took four cues of hesitation. His takes one.*

13.3 SL · JAMIE · Messages — “I’m off to Ohio” — *the scroll-back*

THE SCROLL-BACK. Five years of seeded messages, in order, uncaptioned.

ON SCREEN

THREAD HISTORY — loads whole with the thread:

– May 2024 ·

RECEIVED (gray): “ch. 7 notes attached – coffee thursday?”

RECEIVED (gray) – **PHOTO BUBBLE**: ch7-notes-v2.pdf · 214 KB

– Feb 2025 · 1:14 AM ·

RECEIVED (gray): “still up? this chapter is killing me 😊”

SENT (blue): “for you I’m always up”

– April 2026 ·

RECEIVED (gray): “this stays at the office. agreed?”

SENT (blue): “agreed.”

– Today · 6:04 AM

SENT (blue): “I keep thinking about it”

RECEIVED (gray): “don’t. not over text.”

HOLD · *Fire early and let it run. Recognition is the effect — do not explain it.*

13.4 SL · JAMIE · Messages — “Hold on, facts are facts”

The real dialog, over the real thread: Delete this conversation? His thumb sits on Delete. Never presses.

ON SCREEN

ACTION SHEET slides up over the app – “Delete this conversation? This conversation will be deleted from all your devices.”

buttons: [Delete] (red) · [Cancel]

FINGER RESTS ON [Delete] – the button holds its pressed shade. Not pressing.

HOLD · *He keeps the thread. That is the corner he asks the house for.*

13.5 SL · JAMIE · contact — Nobody needs to know.

Her contact card, mid-edit. ELISE · ED. struck through; R.H. EDITS typed in its place.

ON SCREEN

CONTACT CARD – R.H. EDITS · Random House

name mid-edit: “Elise · Ed.” struck through → “R.H. EDITS” typed in

PHONES SL = contact · stamp “JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN” · clock 6:12

13.6 SL · JAMIE · findmy — (next phrase)

He opens Find My. The confirmation asks if he is sure. He is. “Forever,” from Moving Too Fast, ends on a real button.

ON SCREEN

FIND MY – People: Cathy 📍: W 73rd St · now – sharing Until: Forever

ACTION SHEET slides up over the app – “Stop sharing your location with Cathy?”

buttons: [Stop Sharing] (red) · [Cancel]

FINGER RESTS ON [Stop Sharing] – the button holds its pressed shade. Not pressing.

PRESSES [Stop Sharing]

FIND MY – People: Cathy 📍: You stopped sharing your location

PLAYS

OPENS FindMy — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SL = findmy · stamp “JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN” · clock 6:12

13.7 SL · JAMIE · calevent — THE BRIDGE

He opens Calendar — her opening night, three weeks out — ✓ Accepted, by him, in a life he is dismantling.

ON SCREEN

CALENDAR EVENT – “CATHY – OPENING NIGHT 🎭” · Friday, July 3 · 8:00 PM · in 3 weeks · Medina Summer Theatre, OH

response bar: ✓ Accepted (green)

PLAYS

OPENS Calendar — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SL = calevent · stamp “JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN” · clock 6:12

HOLD · *The only time all song the marriage speaks — and it is a calendar invite.*

13.8 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — (verse 3)

Back to HIM, 7:58. Her good-morning text arrives.

ON SCREEN

LOCK CLOCK – 7:58

NOTIFICATION – Messages · Cathy 🍷 (now): “morning! call me before rehearsal? miss your face”

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE’s screen

cut to Lock screen (instant)

sound: receive ding

SOUND

notification tri-tone (soft)

PHONES SL = Lock screen · stamp “JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN” · clock 7:58

13.9 SL · JAMIE · Lock screen — ON HIS SWIPE

Gone. Unread.

ON SCREEN

notification SWIPED AWAY – slides off and is gone

13.10 SL · JAMIE · settings2 — (next phrase)

He opens Settings → Battery. 9%, Low Power Mode, and the usage table that says where the night went.

ON SCREEN

SETTINGS – Settings > Battery

gauge: 9% · Last charged yesterday, 11:41 PM

· Low Power Mode – ON

· Messages – 6 hr 12 min (top conversation: R.H. EDITS)

· Safari – 1 hr 03 min

PLAYS

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Settings — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

SOUND

unlock swish

PHONES SL = settings2 · stamp “JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN” · clock 7:58

13.11 SL · JAMIE · Messages — FINAL SECTION

Back to Messages — a new, empty conversation. To: |

PLAYS

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SL = Messages · stamp “JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN” · clock 7:58

13.12 SL · JAMIE · Messages — (his last sung phrase)

He types “hey” to someone new.

ON SCREEN

TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “hey”

PLAYS

sound: key clicks

SOUND

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

13.13 SL · JAMIE · Messages — *(as the phrase ends)*

And deletes even that.

ON SCREEN

BACKSPACES the draft to nothing (fast rattle)

PLAYS

sound: backspace rattle

SOUND

rapid delete clicks

13.14 SL · JAMIE · note — *In the silence before the final chord*

Notes. A note called “we need to talk,” edited eleven weeks ago, one line long. He has been carrying the ending since before the fight.

ON SCREEN

NOTES — “we need to talk” · Edited March 24 — 11 weeks ago

cathy —

I don’t know how to start this, so I’ll just say it.

PLAYS

OPENS Notes — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES SL = note · stamp “JUNE 2026 · BEFORE DAWN” · clock 7:58

HOLD · *The last screen of the song. Let it land alone.*

14 · Goodbye Until Tomorrow / I Could Never Rescue You **BOTH**

SING · 12 FIRES

THE GRAMMAR RESOLVES. Her firsts fill as his lasts empty — the same thread from both ends, five years apart.

14.1 **BOTH · CATHY · Lock screen** — *THE DUET BEGINS* — *first vocal entrance*

HER phone. September 2021, 11:58 PM. The night they met.

ON SCREEN

STAMP → “SEPTEMBER 2021 · THE FIRST NIGHT”

LOCK CLOCK — 11:58 · Friday, September 3, 2021

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY’s screen

PHONES BOTH = Lock screen · stamp “SEPTEMBER 2021 · THE FIRST NIGHT” · clock 11:58

14.2 **BOTH · CATHY · contact** — *CATHY: Goodbye until tomorrow* —

She saves his number on a real contact card — then edits it, and adds a sparkle.

ON SCREEN

CONTACT CARD — Jamie ✨ · Added just now

name mid-edit: “Jamie Wellerstein” struck through → “Jamie ✨” typed in

PLAYS

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

SOUND

unlock swish

PHONES BOTH = contact · stamp “SEPTEMBER 2021 · THE FIRST NIGHT” · clock 11:58

14.3 **BOTH · CATHY · Messages** — *CATHY: Goodbye until I crawl to your door* —

His text is already waiting: “home safe?”

ON SCREEN

THREAD HISTORY — loads whole with the thread:

— Today · 11:48 PM

RECEIVED (gray): “home safe?”

PLAYS

cut to Messages (instant)

PHONES BOTH = Messages · stamp “SEPTEMBER 2021 · THE FIRST NIGHT” · clock 11:58

14.4 **BOTH · CATHY · Messages** — *CATHY: “I have been waiting for you!”*

She starts her reply. SHE IS STILL TYPING WHEN THE SHOW ENDS.

ON SCREEN

TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed): “safe 😊 tonight was”

PLAYS

sound: key clicks

SOUND

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

HOLD · *Do not send. This is the payoff of Shiksa Goddess, two hours ago.*

14.5 BOTH · JAMIE · Mail — *JAMIE: I could never rescue you* —

FLIP TO HIS SCREEN. June 2026, 2:40 PM. His inbox is the same three emails she will read on Friday — the sender's side.

ON SCREEN

STAMP → "JUNE 2026 · HIS LAST AFTERNOON"

LOCK CLOCK — 2:40 · Friday, June 12, 2026

INBOX — loads whole, the instant the app opens:

- U-MOVE • — Booking confirmed — Saturday 8:00 AM — 1 bedroom · pickup W 73rd St (2:31 PM)
- Chase — Account closed — joint checking — Confirmation of closure. Funds transferred. (1:55 PM)
- Kessler & Roth LLP — Following our call — Attached, as discussed. Please review at your convenience. (2:50 PM)

PLAYS

the iPhone shell appears — JAMIE's screen

cut to Mail (instant)

no animation — a real inbox does not populate; it is simply THERE, continuing past the bottom edge

PHONES BOTH = Mail · stamp "JUNE 2026 · HIS LAST AFTERNOON" · clock 2:40

14.6 BOTH · JAMIE · Mail — *JAMIE: "I went downtown and closed the bank account"*

His SENT folder. "Some practical things," 4:12 PM, To: Cathy — the email the house read from her side in Still Hurting. THE JOINT ACCOUNT FROM MOVING TOO FAST, CLOSED.

ON SCREEN

SENT — loads whole, the instant the app opens:

- To: Cathy — Some practical things — Cathy — I didn't want to do this over the phone. I went... (4:12 PM)
- To: Kessler & Roth LLP — Re: Following our call — Understood. Go ahead. (3:05 PM)
- To: U-MOVE — Booking — Saturday — Confirmed for 8 AM. One bedroom. (2:12 PM)

PLAYS

no animation — a real inbox does not populate; it is simply THERE, continuing past the bottom edge

HOLD · *The audience watched this open in Act One, and read it arrive in song one.*

14.7 BOTH · JAMIE · music — *JAMIE: All I could do was love you.*

He opens Music — the playlist from 2021. Leave "US"? — this button he CAN press.

ON SCREEN

MUSIC — playlist "US 🎧" · Collaborative Playlist — Jamie & Cathy

♪ (greeked track) — Added by Cathy 🧡

♪ (greeked track) — Added by you

♪ (greeked track) — Added by Cathy 🧡

ACTION SHEET slides up over the app — "Leave "US 🎧"? You will no longer be able to listen with Cathy."

buttons: [Leave Playlist] (red) · [Cancel]

FINGER RESTS ON [Leave Playlist] — the button holds its pressed shade. Not pressing.

PRESSES [Leave Playlist]

banner over the playlist: "You left this playlist"

PLAYS

OPENS Music — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES BOTH = music · stamp "JUNE 2026 · HIS LAST AFTERNOON" · clock 2:40

14.8 BOTH · JAMIE · vm — *JAMIE: I could never rescue you* —

The real Voicemail screen. Cathy — April 9, 2025 — 0:47, saved two years. He presses play; the transcription reads along under his final verse.

ON SCREEN

VOICEMAIL — Cathy 🍷 · April 9, 2025 · 0:47 · SAVED

scrubber: playing at 0:14

transcription: "JAMIE. CALL ME BACK. I GOT OHIO. I GOT—"

PLAYS

OPENS Phone — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

SOUND

voicemail playback: her recorded VO, 0:47

PHONES BOTH = vm · stamp "JUNE 2026 · HIS LAST AFTERNOON" · clock 2:40

HOLD · *The man who empties Recently Deleted keeps her happiest 47 seconds.*

14.9 BOTH · JAMIE · vm — *(verse button)*

Delete Voicemail? His thumb crosses to Delete — and presses Cancel. He keeps this too.

ON SCREEN

ACTION SHEET slides up over the app — "Delete this voicemail?"

buttons: [Delete Voicemail] (red) · [Cancel]

FINGER RESTS ON [Delete Voicemail] — the button holds its pressed shade. Not pressing.

PRESSES [Cancel]

VOICEMAIL — Cathy 🍷 · April 9, 2025 · 0:47 · SAVED

scrubber: stopped at 0:47

transcription: "JAMIE. CALL ME BACK. I GOT OHIO. I GOT—"

SOUND

voicemail playback: her recorded VO, 0:47

14.10 BOTH · JAMIE · Messages — *JAMIE: Goodbye.*

He opens her thread — the same messages the house read at 9:41 this morning, mirrored from his side. All read. Never answered.

ON SCREEN

THREAD HISTORY — loads whole with the thread:

— Monday · 11:02 PM

RECEIVED (gray): "are you coming home this weekend?"

— Wednesday · 8:15 AM

RECEIVED (gray): "please just call me"

— Wednesday · 9:30 PM

RECEIVED (gray): "I still have your ring"

— Today · 9:41 AM

RECEIVED (gray): "I'm not sure that I can do this without you"

— · READ 9:44 AM — he never answered

PLAYS

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap

PHONES BOTH = Messages · stamp "JUNE 2026 · HIS LAST AFTERNOON" · clock 2:40

HOLD · *The image the whole night has been building to.*

14.11 BOTH · JAMIE — *HE puts the key on the table and goes.*

His screen dies.

ON SCREEN**HOUSE BLACK** — the phone vanishes into it**PLAYS**

hard black

SOUND

room tone out

14.12 BOTH · CATHY · Messages — *CATHY: Goodbye until tomorrow. (final)*

BACK TO HER. Five years earlier, still typing. She glows on through the final chord.

ON SCREEN**STAMP** → "SEPTEMBER 2021 · THE FIRST NIGHT"**LOCK CLOCK** — 11:58 · Friday, September 3, 2021**THREAD HISTORY** — loads whole with the thread:

— Today · 11:48 PM

RECEIVED (gray): "home safe?"**TYPES LIVE (keyboard up, keys flashing, self-timed)**: "safe 😊 tonight was"**PLAYS**

the iPhone shell appears — CATHY's screen

UNLOCK — the lock slides up and away → home screen · sound: unlock swish

OPENS Messages — closes the current app if one is open, a beat on the home screen, then the icon itself presses (its real tap animation) and the app opens · sound: tap
sound: key clicks**SOUND**

unlock swish

keyboard clicks (follow the projection rhythm)

PHONES BOTH = Messages · stamp "SEPTEMBER 2021 · THE FIRST NIGHT" · clock 11:58

HOLD · *Hold it. Do not resolve it.*